

EMCEY BROWS AESTHETICS · WEBSITE GUIDE

Setting Up Google & Facebook Reviews

A step-by-step, non-technical walkthrough for connecting your client reviews to the website — including the fully automatic Google reviews feed.

[★ Google Maps](#)[Facebook Recommendations](#)[Auto-updating reviews](#)

Prepared for the Emcey Brows website · Imus, Cavite

Covers: link-out buttons · live Google auto-pull · why Facebook is link-only

What you get

Your website connects to reviews in three ways. Layers 1 and 3 are already built into the site — Layer 3 simply needs one key to switch on.

Layer	What it does	Status	Cost
1. Link-out buttons	Buttons that open your Google & Facebook review pages	✓ Live	Free
2. Manual testimonials	Hand-picked quotes you add in the admin	✓ Available	Free
3. Live Google auto-pull	Real Google reviews shown & refreshed automatically	✓ Built — add key	Google billing (tiny)

The one thing you must do

To turn on automatic Google reviews, create a Google API key and paste it into the site's settings — that's it. Steps are in Section 2.

1 Google reviews — the quick link-out (already done)

On the **Testimonials** page there are buttons that send visitors straight to your Google listing:

- **★ Read Google reviews** — opens your Google Maps listing
- **Write a Google review** — opens Google's review box

These already point at the Emcey Brows listing — nothing to do. If your business listing ever changes, update the Place ID in the site settings (file `lib/site.ts`, value `placeId`).

How to find your Google Place ID (only if it changes)

- 1 Go to Google's Place ID finder: developers.google.com/maps/.../place-id
- 2 Search “**Emcey Brows Aesthetics – Imus**” on the map.
- 3 Copy the **Place ID** shown in the bubble (looks like `ChIJ_x9hcQDT1zMR5JsBByxQ79o`).

2 Turn ON automatic Google reviews

This makes real Google reviews appear on the site and refresh themselves. It is already coded — it only needs a Google API key. Until a key is added, the page safely shows the link-out buttons instead.

Step A — Create the Google key (one time, ~10 min)

- 1 Open the **Google Cloud Console**: console.cloud.google.com and sign in with the clinic's Google account.
- 2 Create a project (top bar → *New Project* → name it "Emcey Brows Website").
- 3 In the search bar type "**Places API (New)**", open it, and click **Enable**.
- 4 Enable **Billing** on the project (a card is required even though normal website use stays within the free monthly allowance).
- 5 Go to **APIs & Services** → **Credentials** → **Create credentials** → **API key**. Copy the key (starts with `AIza...`).
- 6 Click **Edit** on the key → **API restrictions** → restrict it to **Places API (New)** → Save.

Step B — Add the key to the website

Open the site's `.env` file (or your hosting provider's Environment Variables settings) and add this line:

```
GOOGLE_PLACES_API_KEY=AIza...your-key-here...
```

Keep this key private

It has *no* `NEXT_PUBLIC_` prefix on purpose — that keeps it on the server only, so visitors never see it. Don't paste it into public files or chat.

Then **restart / redeploy** the site. Live Google reviews now appear automatically on the Testimonials page.

To turn it OFF

Delete or blank the `GOOGLE_PLACES_API_KEY` line and redeploy. The page falls back to the link-out buttons. No code change needed.

Good to know

- Google returns **up to 5 reviews** and chooses which five — you can't display all of them or pick favourites. To feature a specific review, add it as a manual testimonial (Section 4).
- Reviews are shown unmodified with the Google logo and reviewer name — this is required by Google and already handled.
- The site caches reviews for **24 hours** to stay within Google's free usage and refresh rules.

3 Facebook reviews

Facebook calls reviews “**Recommendations.**” The website already has buttons that open them:

- **Read Facebook reviews** — opens your Page's Reviews tab
- **Recommend us on Facebook** — opens your Page

Make sure your buttons point to the right Page

- 1 Open your Facebook **Page** (not a personal profile).
- 2 Make sure **Reviews/Recommendations are turned on**: Page → *Settings* → *Privacy* → *Page and tagging* (or *Templates and tabs* → enable the **Reviews** tab).
- 3 Confirm these two values in the site settings (file `.env`) match your real Page:

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_FACEBOOK_URL=https://www.facebook.com/profile.php?id=YOUR_PAGE_ID
NEXT_PUBLIC_FACEBOOK_REVIEWS_URL=https://www.facebook.com/profile.php?id=YOUR_PAGE_ID&sk=reviews
```

Why Facebook reviews can't auto-update like Google

Facebook (Meta) shut down public, automatic access to Page reviews. Pulling them now would require a Facebook App, Business Verification, a special “Page Public Content Access” permission with app review, and tokens that expire — fragile and routinely rejected. The reliable approach is the

link-out button

here, plus manually featuring your best Facebook recommendations as testimonials (Section 4).

4 Featuring specific reviews (manual)

For full control — to spotlight your very best Google or Facebook reviews in the homepage slider and testimonials grid — copy them into the admin as testimonials. This is the recommended, fully compliant way to highlight chosen reviews.

- 1 When a client leaves a great review on Google or Facebook, copy the text.
- 2 In the website admin, add a new **Testimonial**: name, star rating, the quote, and (optionally) which service it's about.
- 3 Save — it appears on the homepage and Testimonials page right away.

5 Quick troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause & fix
No Google reviews appear	Key missing/blank, or "Places API (New)" / Billing not enabled in Google Cloud. Re-check Section 2.
Reviews show then vanish	API key restricted too tightly or quota hit. Loosen API restriction to "Places API (New)".
Wrong business shows	<code>placeId</code> in <code>lib/site.ts</code> points to the wrong listing — refresh it (Section 1).
Facebook button opens wrong page	Update <code>NEXT_PUBLIC_FACEBOOK_URL</code> / <code>..._REVIEWS_URL</code> (Section 3).

Where the technical details live

A developer-facing companion document with the exact code files is in the project at `docs/REVIEWS-INTEGRATION.md`.

Emcey Brows Aesthetics — Reviews Setup Guide · Keep your Google API key private · Questions? Contact your website developer.